ACADEMIC AND PROFESSIONAL LEADERSHIP
Dimensions, Dysfunctions and Dynamics

Dr Tom Kennie

1. Introduction

In this paper I tentatively suggest some of the more distinctive characteristics and practices which are associated with the particular challenges of leading academics and professionals. My starting hypothesis is that the component dimensions and the practice of 'academic and professional' leadership vary in a number of ways from those processes associated more with 'managerial and organisational' leadership, whilst also recognising, as illustrated below (Figure 1), that an area of common territory also exists.

Figure 1

In order to explore this assumption further I have developed a conceptual framework which builds on prior work by Andrew Munro, a fellow consultant, and on my personal experience as a academic, a professional and as a coach working with many academic leaders in a wide range of organisational settings. The framework is based on the six different dimensions of academic/professional leadership as shown in Figure 2 overleaf.

The paper then develops these *dimensions* and offers examples of some of the ways in which effective leaders deploy them in these contexts. This is followed by considering the other side of leadership - the *dysfunctions* – which can cause a leader to fail or temporarily derail. Finally, I conclude with some early thinking about the *dynamics* at work in the model, based on the interplay and patterns which arise from different combinations of its six key factors.

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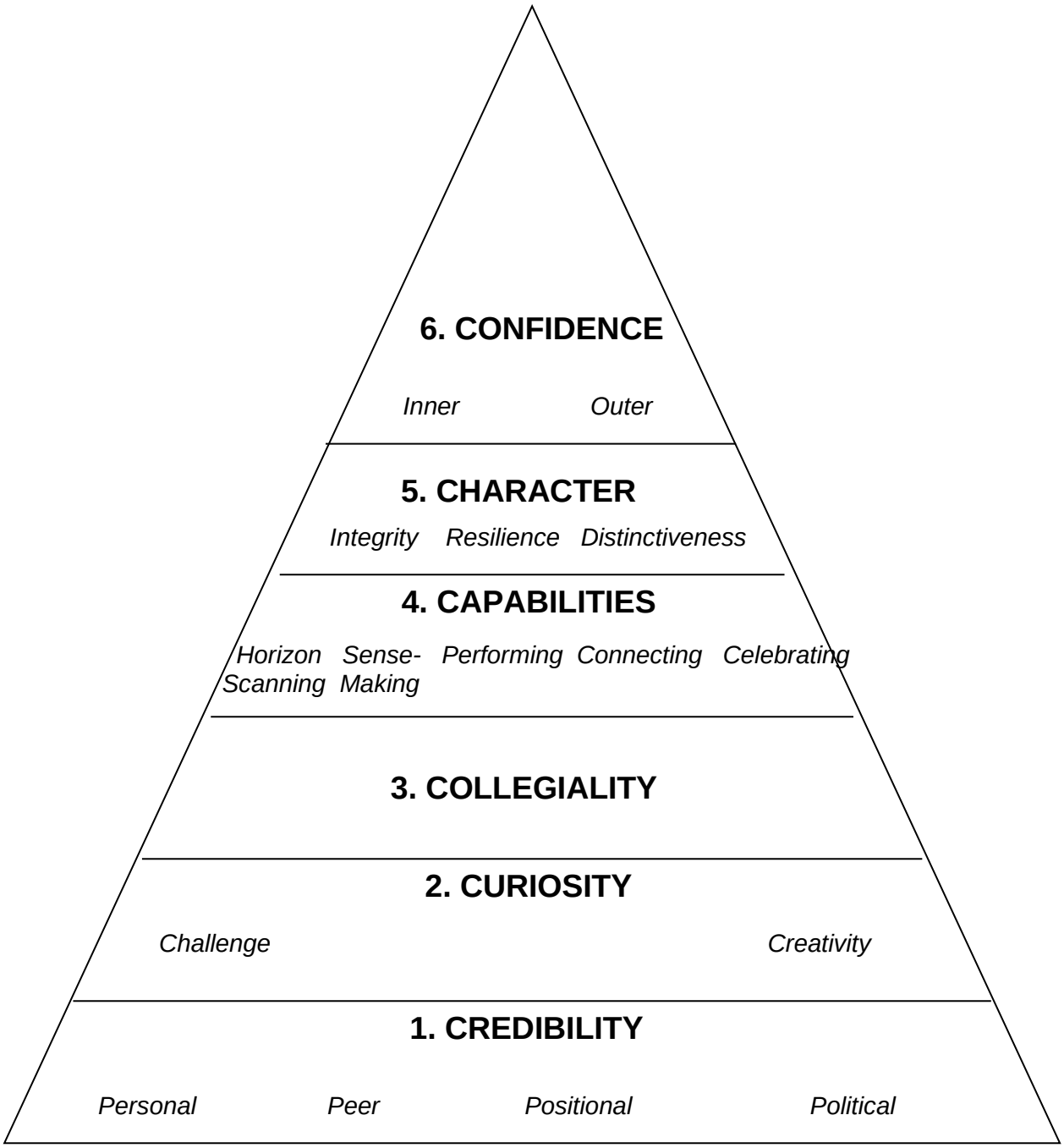
Figure 2: Some Dimensions and Domains of Academic/Professional Leadership



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2 Dimensions of Academic/Professional Leadership

2.1 Credibility

A further hypothesis I propose is that academic/professional leadership can only be truly practiced if the academic/professional leader has built a strong foundation of credibility. Without this fundamental underpinning, I suggest that the necessary conditions for leadership will be not be in place and the ability to lead is likely to be severely limited; indeed leadership may even in some situations become impossible. I suggest that credibility needs to be demonstrated and earned in four domains, namely:

***2.1.1 Personal credibility*:** Personal academic/professional credibility as illustrated through (say) the gaining of relevant qualifications, typically (but not exclusively) through obtaining a PhD, undertaking subsequent post-doctoral work and through evidence of past and current academic/professional achievements.

***2.1.2 Peer credibility*:** Builds from personal credibility and is apparent through the opinions and positive judgements of peer members of the academic/professional community which help build and develop the academic/professional leader's reputation.

***2.1.3 Positional credibility*:** Is an extension of personal and peer credibility and arises when, with peer support, the academic/professional leader reaches a position of influence and authority (e.g. Head of Academic Group, Department, School). Positional credibility develops from successfully building the reputation of the wider academic/professional unit, well beyond that of the academic/professional leader's personal or group reputation.

***2.1.4 Political credibility*:** Particularly, although not only, at the more senior levels of academic/professional leadership, credibility is further enhanced by being able to read and deal well with the inevitable political challenges which arise in Higher Education (HE). These might include, for example, having to deal with the perception and positioning of your academic/professional unit in the department or institution, or with negative politics which may arise from the perceptions of peers, and so on.

2.2 Curiosity

The second dimension in the framework is premised around the hypothesis that effective academic/professional leaders possess and demonstrate consistently high levels of academic/professional curiosity. They have an infectious fascination for their discipline – well beyond their own personal field of interest. Single scholars or lone scholars clearly also need this to succeed. However, academic/professional leaders require, I suggest, curiosity on a wider scale to engage and inspire others. Whether innate or invoked, it needs to be authentic. Through this intellectual curiosity, academic/professional leaders also exhibit two other important attributes:

***2.2.1 Challenge*:** Through engagement with others academic/professional leaders set and develop the academic/professional agenda for their unit. Collins and Porras (2004) suggested to 'managerial leaders' that they need to articulate the BHAG (a Big, Hairy Audacious Goal) for their team or organisation; they define a 'BHAG' (bee-hag) as being a goal which is *'clear and compelling, serving as a unifying focal point of effort, acting as a clear catalyst for team spirit, it has a clear finish line, so the organization can know when it has achieved the goal'.*

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In an educational context, I contend that academic/professional leaders do need to do this but also need to establish the Big Hairy *Academic/professional* Goal. This becomes the challenge – whether it is to sequence the human genome or is simply to incrementally analyse some new data, academic/professional leader's use intellectual challenges to constantly set the agenda for the wider group.

Developing this culture of intellectual challenge is key. Ideas are openly challenged, no intellectual 'sacred cows' are permitted. The leader's role is to be able to clarify the challenge – and also challenge the group to address these academic/professional questions. To do so requires the second dimension of curiosity – that of

***2.2.2 Creativity*:** Breakthroughs in any area of enquiry typically demand a different way of looking at a problem or world view of a topic. To facilitate breakthroughs, academic/professional leaders need to foster the conditions which lead to intellectual risk taking. Creating a culture where creativity is encouraged is a key function of the academic/professional leader. Whether through brainstorming, using in-house seminars, arranging visits to other organisations' or institutions, the leader makes every effort to facilitate and encourage new ways of thinking and the challenging of existing assumptions.

2.3 Collegiality

My third dimension is a further prerequisite for effectiveness and builds on the foundations of credibility and curiosity. Collegiality is an 'old fashioned' term which has become somewhat lost in many aspects of life in HE, and yet, I would contend, in the development of academic/professional leadership it is of critical importance.

From an outsider's perspective, academic/professional leadership might be perceived as being undertaken in a context which is highly competitive - a no holds barred, hyper-challenging environment. All of which is true. However, in addition, much of this competition over intellectual work is undertaken in conditions where there is also an open sharing of ideas, the contribution of colleagues in the field is encouraged and a willingness to offer help to others is widely practiced.

Of course, academic/professional mavericks who plagiarise others' work, steal ideas from (often junior) colleagues and who selfishly don't contribute to the academic/professional unit, clearly exist. A very few become the equivalent of Nobel Prize winners in their field. Most don't. The vast majority of consistently effective academic/professionals and academic/professional leaders contribute selflessly to the wider academic/professional context, be it at a team, discipline, departmental, professional or institutional level. They recognise the need for good academic/professional citizenship. Without this, much of the infrastructure of academic/professional life would collapse. Peer reviewing of papers, funding requests, providing references, mentoring junior colleagues, offering comments or thoughts on an early draft paper etc, all take time and intellectual effort and this is a part of the collegial aspect of academic/professional life; academic/professional leaders need to demonstrate this personally and encourage the process in others.

2.4 Capabilities

My fourth dimension is probably the one area where the greatest level of overlap with 'managerial' leadership exists. In this domain, however, whilst the functions might be familiar, the emphasis is also slightly different from an exclusively managerial perspective. I suggest 5 main domains which I describe as follows:

- Horizon scanning
- Sense-making and planning
- Performing (including style)
- Connecting
- Celebrating.

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***2.4.1 Horizon Scanning*:** Success in any field requires close attention to the wider external context and an ability to adapt accordingly. Horizon scanning helps to inform the leader's approach to the future agenda. Whether it involves knowing where future funding streams will come from or what other groups in the same field are doing (or planning to do), the process is critical and similar to that in other fields. In relation to academic/professional leadership however, it also involves a further dimension: the ability to scan the *intellectual horizons* to identify new disciplinary, inter- or multi-disciplinary openings, new or novel problems, or new or novel applications of existing practice to new contexts. Successful academic/professional leaders, I suggest, combine *managerial* horizon scanning with *intellectual* horizon scanning to a much greater degree than in other contexts.

***2.4.2 Sense-making and planning*:** No amount of horizon scanning can compensate for the capacity to make sense of any findings and translate them into tangible plans and actions. Successful academic/professional leaders recognise the importance of having clear plans and of preparing for possible contingencies before they become critical. Ensuring the continuity of an academic/professional field of enquiry also requires regular infusions of new ideas, sources of funding and plans for succession when key players depart for promoted posts or the founder of the team moves on or retires.

***2.4.3 Performing*:** In some fields of academic/professional inquiry a single contribution may make such an impact that it becomes a seminal work in the field. In many other cases consistent performance over long periods of time is more likely to be key to success. To facilitate 'performing', the academic/professional leader will need the skills to deliver high levels of output by their team. As mentioned earlier, the skills in this territory overlap very much with those required by leaders in other more managerial contexts: defining outcomes, setting standards, regular review of performance, managing conflict, and so on.

There is, however, at least one area where the academic/professional leader's approach to 'managing' performance is more pronounced. That is in relation to protecting the individual and the team from distracting forces which may limit their ability to make progress on the *academic/professional* BHAG mentioned earlier. The academic/professional leader will need, on occasions, to protect the team and act as a 'semi-permeable membrane' allowing some of the internal organisation issues to seep through (the chill wind of reality) whilst at the same time shielding the team from some of these demands. Whatmore (1998) offers further insights into these processes in his work on the process of leading creative groups as do Goffee and Jones in their work on fostering and leading 'clever people' (Goffee and Jones, 2009). A further area of particular importance in the academic/professional leaders skill set relates to the style adopted in particular, I suggest, in relation to the degree of intervention and support offered by the leader in different circumstances. The following figure illustrates the differing styles which the academic/professional leader may need to deploy.

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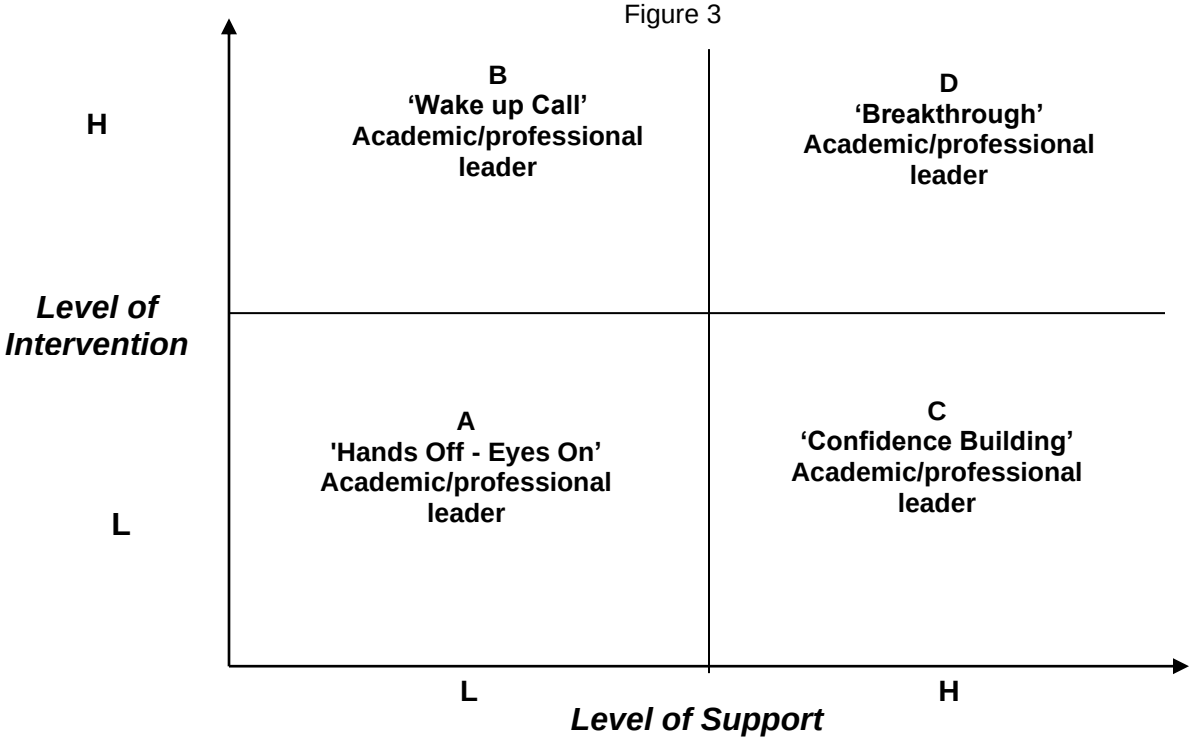
Figure 3



Style A: The 'Hands Off - Eyes On' Academic/professional Leader

I believe this style is of particular importance in the academic/professional context – the ability to provide space for team members to explore their academic/professional interests without interference, albeit within the constraints of some broadly agreed area of intellectual challenge. This style has similarities to the 'laissez faire' approach in 'managerial' leadership. What distinguishes it in this context is the balancing influence of 'eyes on' – a constant, at a distance observation of progress. Without this it will be difficult to judge which of the other three more interventionist styles might be required. Depending on the evidence which arises the leader may respond as follows:

Style B: The 'Wake up Call' Academic/professional leader

This more interventionist style arises when there is a need to provide a 'prod to action' or to enhance commitment to the project outcomes. The low(er) level of support is used intentionally to encourage the team member to reframe or refocus their current approach.

Style C: The 'Confidence Building' Academic/professional leader

This style comes into play when evidence of lack of progress is perceived as not to be related to a lack of effort but more related to a lack of confidence. In this situation a more supportive style is necessary.

Style D: The 'Breakthrough' Academic/professional leader

Movement to this high interventional (with high support) style may arise when the academic/professional leader has seen evidence of real intellectual progress which also has promise and which could lead to a 'breakthrough' in the work being undertaken. The leader 'raises the bar' considerably, a need for say more

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data, more evidence, a deeper evaluation of the archived material, a closer look at some outliers and so on but within a highly supportive context - we might call it the Barack Obama style 'yes we can'!

***2.4.4 Connecting*:** The fourth area of capability I have identified is that of developing connections, both internally and externally. The work of academic/professional leaders in most fields can be enhanced by the contributions of others in the wider intellectual community. Indeed many academic/professional leaders often have much stronger links with their wider external community than with their host institution. Peer collaborators, access to private and public data sources, access to instrumentation in other institutions will all depend on the building of an academic/professional network. This becomes even more crucial when leading an academic/professional group. Academic/professional leaders are also often uniquely positioned to connect up team members who might be working independently but who would benefit from sharing the thinking. This connecting role is a crucial skill in the repertoire of academic/professional leaders.

***2.4.5 Celebrating*:** The fifth domain is in the area of celebration. Peer influence is a major force for encouraging the right behaviours and constraining those behaviours which are less beneficial to an academic/professional group. The positive reinforcement of success through celebration of individual and group achievements can be of real value. Not only does it act as a powerful source of individual motivation, it also builds cohesion within an academic/professional team and ultimately builds enhanced levels of loyalty to the group. Time spent on celebrating success (a paper accepted for publication, a first conference presentation, a new grant etc) can often be perceived (inappropriately) as 'wasting' time and money which should be spent elsewhere. I suggest this view is seriously misguided.

Peer 'pressure' can also be used to influence situations where performance needs to be enhanced. Of course the academic/professional leader needs to be competent at providing feedback but they also need to be open to using the collective force of the group to change behaviour.

2.5 Character

The notion of 'character' in relation to leadership evolved from the use of this dimension in the area of managerial leadership (based on earlier work by my colleague Andrew Munro) and is based on the three sub-elements of integrity, resilience and distinctiveness. I believe they remain of significance in the academic/professional leadership domain. However, I suggest that they play out in different ways.

***2.5.1 Integrity*:** Integrity is central to all aspects of academic/professional inquiry. Integrity of data, of interpretation, of contribution, of presentation for example. In the academic/professional leadership domain it is equally critical. Do standards exist and are they upheld in relation to ethics, plagiarism, recognising contributions? Without high ethical standards, academic/professional leadership can become exploitative, dishonest and ultimately toxic as minor blemishes or oversights lead, over time, to seriously flawed and unethical practices.

***2.5.2 Resilience*:** If the old adage that academic/professional success is 10% inspiration and 90% perspiration is only half true, it suggests that academic/professional leaders require the capacity to keep going personally when they find themselves 'up an academic/professional 'cul de sac' or with inadequate resources to complete a project. Such resilience is also crucially important in relation to leading academic/professional s. Sticking with it, not giving up in the face of opposition, having a capacity to deal with helpful (and unhelpful) critique and keep focused on an agreed strategy all demand the ability to call upon reserves of resilience.

They also need the ability to inspire others to keep going, to have that inner strength when others are questioning their results (or lack thereof), their interpretation of results, or their opinions. All take enormous amounts of courage and intellectual resilience.

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***2.5.3 Distinctiveness*:** Academic/professional reputations are demonstrated and sustained on the basis of becoming known and respected through a series of distinctive contributions. As an academic/professional leader, building a distinctive reputation is a key function. Finding that distinctive area to explore is a vital first step. Academic/professional leaders also hold the key to developing a distinctive reputation for their team. To achieve this requires a willingness to share some of the academic/professional recognition by enabling those who are developing their careers to, for example, have an opportunity to present at conferences or to report results to an influential funder.

2.6 Confidence

The final level in our conceptual model is that of 'confidence'. This dimension is one which one might find also shared with a more 'managerial' approach to leadership. Again, however, I sense that this process plays out in a number of different ways through a balance of both *'inner intellectual confidence'* and a broader *'external confidence'.*

***2.6.1 Inner Intellectual Confidence*:** All good academic/professional leader needs to possess a degree of intellectual strength and confidence if they are to take forward and develop their ideas. The very process of being willing to challenge conventional wisdom, the existing paradigm and the assumptions on which current knowledge is founded, takes intellectual confidence. This inner intellectual confidence also allows the academic/professional leader to be more comfortable in the company of others who approach their work in a very different way. A lack of such 'intellectual groundedness' I believe will ultimately limit the leader's effectiveness.

In addition to that inner confidence there will also be occasions when the academic/professional leader has to fulfill, on behalf of the group, an advocacy role or ambassadorial function. These and other role expectations will require the academic/professional leader to exhibit a degree of *confidence externally*. This should not be confused with having an extrovert personality. How this confidence is displayed is much less important that the willingness to represent the group beyond the internal context. In some types of academic/professional work this may become a critical skill, particularly in cases where the ability to present evidence to stakeholders or funders is central to the ongoing success of the unit.

3. Dysfunctions of Academic/Professional Leaders

The managerial leadership literature contains a number of studies of the factors which can cause dysfunctional behaviours and which may subsequently lead to the early derailment or dismissal of a leader. For example McCall 1998 explored this in relation to perceived 'high flyers' in executive positions, Lencioni, 2003, in relation to dysfunctions in teams, and Dotlich and Cairo, 2003, in relation to the derailment of chief executives. More recently Kennie and Middlehurst, 2021 explored this in relation to Presidents and Vice Chancellors in universities.

As in other areas of academic, much less has been written about the equivalent influences on academic/professional leaders. Are they the same or do they present themselves in different ways? What leads some academic/professional leaders to fail? As a basis for developing the idea, I will now use the initial 6 'C' model (see Figure 2) to offer a few examples (which are far from exhaustive).

3.1 Credibility

One of the first signs of dysfunction in the credibility dimension arises when it becomes apparent, despite all the evidence, qualifications and prior references, that the academic/professional leader isn't quite as good as had been expected. A bit as with some sixth formers who have been tutored to gain the grades to get into university, the signs of early promise fail to lead to tangible outcomes, despite ongoing support and mentoring. *Personal credibility* is being tested. A further worrying sign of credibility occurs as the

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academic/professional leader struggles to establish a clear academic/professional plan or seems overly cautious in determining their academic/professional territory; peers begin to feel anxious that the broader reputation of the unit may suffer and gradually rumours grow (as might students' complaints). The academic/professional leader needs to re-establish *peer credibility*. Worries about *positional credibility* emerge when those new to formal positions of authority begin to exhibit signs that they are 'not coping'. The signs can be many and varied and include, for example:

- an inability to separate their historical allegiance to their previous academic group (to which they still may remain connected), from the wider unit responsibilities, leading to concerns about favouritism. Alternatively, they become overly distant and fail to maintain and retain their relationships within their academic 'home', for fear of being accused of giving undue benefit to this group.

- an overly authoritative style when dealing with problems, or conversely, an overly hands-off style and avoidance of taking difficult decisions,

and so on.

Derailment due to a lack of *political credibility* is probably the most challenging, and possibly one of the most common reasons for failure at the more senior levels of academic/professional leadership. An inability (or unwillingness) to read the political environment, to assess where the 'wind is blowing' politically, where the power lies and a lack of awareness of how not to alienate oneself from peers and more senior colleagues may all lead, eventually, to derailment.

3.2 Curiosity

Dysfunctional behaviour in this dimension may also arise for a variety of reasons, for example, from a lack of openness to the ideas and approaches to intellectual enquiry used by others. Combined with a powerful personal intellect and intellectual confidence this combination may, sadly, if not addressed, create the conditions for failure. What starts as *'intellectual groundedness'* becomes *'intellectual arrogance',* the lack of flexibility comes across as an unwillingness to value others' contribution and slowly the leader becomes isolated and, in time, loses the respect of the group.

A second example in this domain may arise from an overly ambitious BHAG well beyond the resources of the group (to challenge Harvard's position in this field in the next 2 years), or, alternatively, to set far too low a level of challenge which does not engage the ambitions and desires of the team.

Of course, some academic/professional leaders do manage to succeed without great strength in this dimension. Through sheer force of personal intellectual power (and hard work) they inspire others – for a while. Ultimately, however, failure may eventually occur unless they can adapt their approach.

3.3 Collegiality

The corridors of campuses across the country contain examples of 'Maverick' academic/professionals. These are the individuals who avoid any number of work expectations; teaching, submission of routine requests for information, appraisals, committee membership (or chairing), and so on. They flaunt the rules, they appear to be impervious to peer pressure – and they can be extremely successful academic/professional ally. Paradoxically they are often strongly collegial in relation to their own field and with their own team, but any attempt to gain a greater contribution to the work of the wider department, school or institution seems to fall on (largely) deaf ears.

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Promoted into positions of authority, these ‘non-collegial’ types store up problems which ultimately begin to escalate. With a limited interest in wider academic/professional issues, their desire to invest effort in building a collective reputation remains very much a secondary (or tertiary) interest. Taking on the role as ‘Head’ (whether of a academic group, department or school) can so often be (or become) either an ego trip (it’s the next natural step on the hierarchy of ‘success’, and by the way I’ve never failed in my career) or it is more of a defensive strategy (there is no way I can cope with Dr / Prof X becoming Head). Either way it’s a train crash waiting to happen. Thankfully no loss of life, but sadly quite a lot of ‘life’ is lost by all dealing with the consequences of either a battle of egos or a battle to maintain the status quo (often despite the rhetoric of the new academic/professional leader about *'the need for change’, ‘get rid of dead wood’, 'give this place some real academic/professional leadership').*

The danger of losing collegiality is that it often takes as long to regain as it took to obtain. For some it can be a serious career limiting factor.

3.4 Capabilities

For those who survive the challenges of credibility loss, curiosity limitations and collegial low water, the dangerous rocks of capability gaps may now become apparent.

It’s not easy to move from being a singularly successful individual, with an international following and an adoring team at home, to miraculously become a selfless servant of a wider unit (some of whom are your arch enemies or with whom you have ‘previous’). Personal achievement and success need to become secondary to the success of the wider unit. Well, perhaps not completely (since you still need to retain your credibility after all) and at the back of your mind you might also need to return to the ‘back benches’.

Those in academic/professional leadership positions who can walk this delicate balancing act of

- looking out for the wider team, listening to others and creating a collective, shared agenda,
- confronting those who do not (always) comply with the collegial needs of the unit (particularly now that you as leader are recognising how important this discretionary effort is to the broader success of the unit), and
- working with the senior opinion formers whilst also encouraging the next generation of leaders (often trying ‘gently’ to ameliorate their tendencies to behave as you did at that stage in your career),

whilst in the process trying to meet the many the expectations which are placed on them by their colleagues are likely to be successful.

Good academic/professional leaders also manage to navigate these by working with others to cover for their inevitable blind spots. They (often suddenly) see the value of professional administration (now appropriately recognised as ‘professional services’). Some cope, others find it intellectually stimulating, not the administrative backwater they expected. Thankfully some seek help, recognise this is a territory where some leadership development might be of value (although for some I do sometimes wonder why it is that whilst working in the ‘education’ business they find it so difficult to recognise that education might be of value to themselves!). The brave (as seen by some peers) enlist the help of a mentor.

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3.5 Character

The next set of hills or the climb towards the peak of academic/professional leadership lies in the foothills of 'character'. With a good degree of self insight, hard work and an ability to work with others to cover known weaknesses (or areas being developed), it should be possible to make real progress as an academic/professional leader. Sadly, this may not always be possible. The dysfunctions and derailers in this dimension are often subtle and quite beguiling. Three possible examples are:

***3.5.1 Integrity*:** Any number of new temptations can now derail the successful academic/professional leader: the limited but nevertheless available access to funds for travel and entertainment; the lure of opportunities to get involved in external (often international) activities too early; avoiding dealing with the harder to solve problems at home; the opportunity to offer (too much) help to a junior colleague in your current or 'old' field who you feel should be supported in a promotion round; the 'value' of a PA who can not only help with your administrative arrangements, but also perhaps with aspects of your personal life. Where do the boundaries lie in this new uncharted water? How do you judge what to do? This is where personal values and integrity become particularly important.

***3.5.2 Resilience*:** Most academic/professional leaders are hard working and committed individuals. Indeed, it is usually rare that they are ineffective in this respect. Successful academic/professional s are quite the opposite committing themselves fully to the tasks in hand. Working through evenings, weekends, holidays, they embrace the full challenges of their new academic/professional and administrative workload. For a while the adrenalin rush of this is exhilarating, like skiing on fresh snow, making speedy progress (with the odd unexpected and somewhat terrifying black run!). However, without some form of governor or limiter on their rev counter, the academic/professional leader may well be in serious danger of over stressing their engine and, fairly obviously, over time heading for a dangerous end to their period in office.

***3.5.3 Distinctiveness*:** Our third potential derailer occurs (sadly) just as the academic/professional leader seems to be beginning to actually enjoy the process. The reputation of the unit is growing, they have made a noticeable difference and this is recognised by others, who can genuinely see that the collective efforts the leader has engendered in the group are making a difference. Sadly, however, there is a danger at this point of cruising a little, letting go and allowing the place to run itself for a while. Perhaps the leader feels the need for that extended period of academic time to re-connect with their personal academic/professional interests. For a while, not much happens (particularly if they have done some good work in building the team). Over time, however, unless someone guides and facilitates the process of connecting up the component parts, the distinctive reputation which was developing begins to fragment again, the dangers of 'silos' forming (or re-forming) become greater and boundary spats between groups may begin to emerge - when the cats away... Developing a distinctive reputation for a group takes time; retaining and developing it takes even more time and effort.

3.6 Confidence

I have already alluded to the potential danger signs when confidence begins to appear as arrogance, when intellectual sharpness becomes used with rapier like precision to 'put others down' or expose weaknesses in an intellectual argument being put forward by others (possibly more junior). Acceptable to a limited degree in private, when these behaviours begin to dominate the public space trouble lies ahead.

When intellectual confidence is combined with an overly expressive external persona, the result further exacerbates the problem. The leader dominates the debates, over eggs the success of the unit whilst also being seen by many others as being in denial about issues which need attention. These types gradually become distanced by their peer 'Heads' - they are heading for a fall, but can't see that their shoelaces are

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undone (or have been undone intentionally by someone else!). They have just stopped listening enough to others.

An apparent lack of confidence can also become a derailer, for instance through a lack of recognition of the need to act as an advocate on behalf of the team (the leader fails to recognise the need at times to be the servant of the team, particularly in situations where you may have 'lost' the case on a particular issue). They avoid speaking up when they should be representing your unit's position. They use the anonymous 'the university won't agree to our position' to hide their lack of courage to push the agenda.

4. Dynamics of Academic/Professional Leadership

In this penultimate section I consider the way in which the various dimensions may interact with each other and, in so doing, add a further dynamic aspect to the model. As a basis for exploring this I offer the following model which shows the six dimensions in a 'spidergram'. The dimensions of the model are independent factors, although some could conceivably be more correlated - say credibility and capabilities - where it is probable that high (or low) score on one is likely to lead to an equivalent score on the other dimension. Others, such as curiosity and collegiality may be correlated but could equally be quite different.

To aid interpretation, I have developed a pilot self-assessment tool to enable individuals to identify to what extent they have strengths or areas of potential weakness in each of these factors. On the basis of the relative effectiveness on each dimension, it is possible to create schematically an academic/professional leadership profile as shown by the figures which follow:

Figure 4

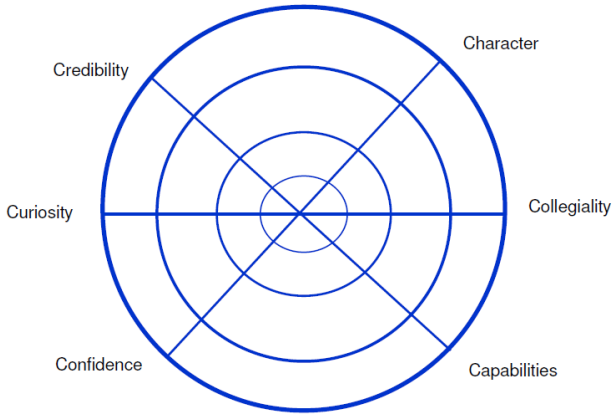

Figure 5

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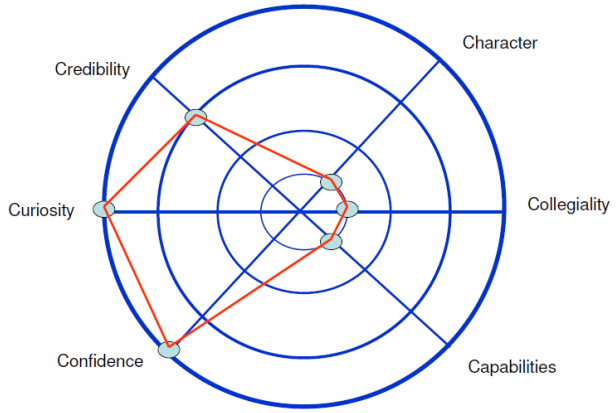
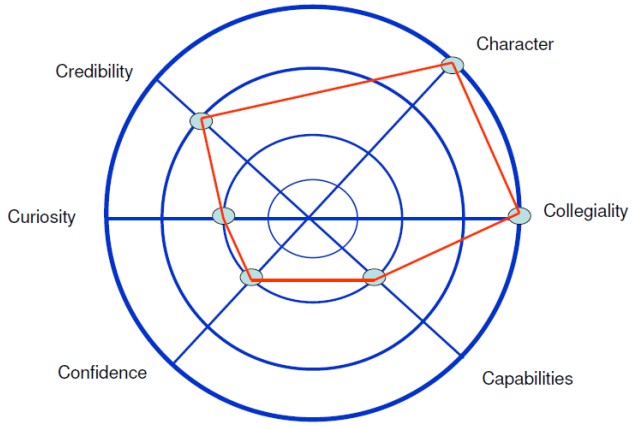


Figure 6



To reach any detailed conclusion about the issues to be resolved in each case would clearly require more contextual information and a more detailed examination of the responses to the questions. However, even without this, one may be able to identify some interesting issues for exploration on the basis of these contrasting profiles.

For example, in Figure 5 the dangerous combination of high self-confidence with a corresponding low self - awareness on the character dimension looks somewhat worrying, particularly if the character sub-dimension of integrity is also low. Might this leader be in danger of pushing through changes perhaps by using their positional authority inappropriately and 'cutting corners' in a way which would be judged by others as unethical? The high curiosity, low collegiality combination might also be a cause for reflection. Is this a case of a highly effective lone scholar who recognises the importance of team working in their academic/professional leadership role? Or possibly a lone scholar who fails to give recognition for those who selflessly engage in being good academic/professional citizens? Combined with the low character score, this could be a somewhat toxic mix.

The profile represented by Figure 6, on the other hand, would lead to a different set of issues for exploration. This type of profile reflects a highly collegial colleague who is considered very credible and who is likely to demonstrate strong ethical behaviors and resilience. On the other hand they are not currently projecting a confident persona. Is this as a consequence of personal issues not associated with their role or is it more associated with anxiety about their field of intellectual endeavour? Are they feeling concerned

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about losing touch with their academic, or feeling overwhelmed by the demands being placed on them by others (given their high level of collegiality?

A copy of the self-assessment questionnaire to enable individuals to evaluate themselves on these dimensions is available for pilot usage.

5. Conclusions

This paper is intended to act as a catalyst for further exploration of the concept of 'academic/professional' leadership and how it differs from more 'managerial' interpretations of leadership. I have suggested a conceptual framework which will be evaluated and refined in the light of experience. The paper has also highlighted the need also to consider the potential dysfunctions which can arise when one or more of the dimensions is over- or under-played. Finally, the dynamic interplay between the various high level dimensions is highlighted as a potential means by which the relative strengths and developmental aspects of academic/professional leadership can be explored.

The next step in the development of this work will be to gain feedback from others involved in academic/professional leadership and leadership development. On the basis of this, it is hoped that a more complete model and associated diagnostic tools may be developed to help both new and experienced academic/professional leaders to be even more competent in the skills and processes required '*to herd those academic/professional cats'.*

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Dr Tom Kennie is a founding Director of Ranmore (www.ranmore.co.uk) He can be contacted at tkennie@ranmore.co.uk

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